Inside Out

By Suzanne Francis

Adapted from the screenplay by Peter Doctor, Meg Lafauve and Josh Cooley

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Suggested Roles
ACTOR 1: *Narrator 1, Joy, Anger, Teacher*
ACTOR 2: *Narrator 2, Sadness, Fear, Disgust, Riley*

NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 1-6)** On the day Riley was born, Joy found herself inside a strange and beautiful place.

NARRATOR 2: Riley's mind. [You see] Joy was a glowing collection of yellow energy particles and was one of Riley's Emotions.

NARRATOR 1: Joy thought it would just be her and Riley forever . . . but 33 seconds later *(Riley begins to wail)*

SADNESS: I'm Sadness

NARRATOR 1: As time went on, more Emotions showed up inside Headquarters. And with each new Emotion, memories started rolling through in different colored spheres. Purple

FEAR: Look out!

NARRATOR 1: Disgust was green

DISGUST: Ewwwwwwww!

ANGER: *(scowling, screaming, growling)*

NARRATOR 2: That's Anger . . . short, red and . . . . *(makes a face)* angry.

NARRATOR 1: Joy could see why all of them were important . . . except for Sadness. She tried her best to keep Sadness as far from the controls as possible.

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NARRATOR 2: Most of Riley's memories were golden, just like Joy. And the most important ones glowed brighter

NARRATOR 1: Core memories! They power the Islands of Personality:

NARRATOR 2: Hockey Island! Goofball Island, Family Island – And there's Honesty and Friendship Island – Like mini theme parks!

NARRATOR 1: Riley had a very happy childhood, but when she was 11 years old, her parents made a major decision that changed everything.

NARRATOR 2: Riley's dad started a new business and the family moved from Minnesota to San Francisco.

FEAR: Look out!

DISGUST: Ewwwwwwww!

ANGER: *(scowling, screaming, growling)*

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *According to Psych Central, our society expects us to "appear happy."*

ACTOR 2: *Messages to be "strong" and have "good vibes" rule on social media, but the encouragement to steer clear of sadness often starts in childhood.*

ACTOR 1: *Grownups angrily tell kids to stop crying, even when they have a "good reason." And we learn early that being sad makes us, and others, uncomfortable.*

ACTOR 2: *Inside Out reminds us to embrace the wholeness of ourselves, and gives us permission to not be "okay."*

ACTOR 1: *After all, you can't be happy ALL the time.*

ACTOR 2: *Inside Out adapted by Suzanne Francis*

ACTOR 1: *From the screenplay by Peter Docter, Meg Lafauve and Josh Cooley*

NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 7-8)** The car ride was long and when Dad finally drove down their new block

(Riley looks excited for a moment as she stares at the new house, but her emotions can't be kept in check)

JOY: *(hopefully)* Maybe it's nice on the inside

ANGER: We're supposed to live here?

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FEAR: Can you die from moving?

DISGUST: I'm gonna be sick.

SADNESS: Oh, Riley can't live here . . .

NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 17-19)** The first night in the new house was uncomfortable and creepy. Riley had to sleep in a sleeping bag on the floor. And inside Headquarters . .

FEAR: *(reacting to a noise)* Was it a bear? It's a bear! I'm so jumpy. My nerves are shot.

JOY: Look, I get it. You have concerns, but we've been through worse!

DISGUST: *(Sarcastically)* Yeah, Joy. We could be lying on a dirty floor . . . in a sleeping bag.

JOY: But think of all the good things . . .

ANGER: No! There's absolutely no reason for Riley to be happy right now.

FEAR: I say we skip school tomorrow and lock ourselves in the bedroom.

SADNESS: Yeah, we could cry until we can't breathe. **(Pg 15)** Something's wrong with me. It's like I'm having a breakdown. I'm awful . . . and annoying.

NARRATOR 1: Sadness constantly focused on the negative.

NARRATOR 2: While Joy saw the rain as a fun opportunity for Riley to jump in puddles and carry a cool umbrella, Sadness liked when the rain made Riley feel soggy and droopy.

JOY: **(Pg 19)** Now hold on. **(Pg 21)** We are not going to end the day like this. *(She shifts through the memory spheres and selects a golden one)*

NARRATOR 2: And then she recalled a memory of Riley showcasing all her ice-skating moves on the lake with her parents. *(Riley drifts off to sleep with a smile on her face)*

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JOY: **(Pg 22-24)** *(Waking up with tons of energy)* Okay! First day of school. Very exciting! Disgust. Make sure Riley stands out today . . . but also blends in.

DISGUST: When I'm through, Riley will look so good the other kids will look at their own outfits and bar.

JOY: *(to Sadness)* I have a super important job just for you. *(She takes a piece of chalk and draws a circle around Sadness)* This is the circle of Sadness. Your job is to make sure that

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ALL the Sadness stays inside it. *(Beat – Sadness tries to put a foot outside the circle, but Joy blocks her)* Isn't it fun?

SADNESS: *(exceedingly glum)* No . . . .

JOY: All right, everyone. We are going to have a good day, which will turn into a good week, a good year and a good LIFE!

NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 26-27)** Riley waled to her new school. There were tons of students and the school as so big.

FEAR: Are you sure we want to do this?

DISGUST: Okay. We've got a group of cool girls at two o-clock. *(Disgust turning to excitement)* Double ears pierced, infinity scarves . . . We want to be friends with them.

FEAR: Worst case scenario is either quicksand, spontaneous combustion, or getting called on by the teacher. So long as none of those happen . . .

TEACHER: Okay, everybody. We have a new student in class today.

FEAR: Are you kidding me? Out of the gate? Noooooo! Pretend we can't speak English!

JOY: **(Pg 28-30)** Don't worry. I got this!

RILEY: *(Smiling)* My name is Riley Anderson. I'm from Minnesota . . . *(continues to speak silently)*

NARRATOR 1: She told them about being on an ice hockey team, the Prairie Dogs, and how it was a family tradition. But then something very strange happened.

JOY: Sadness! You touched a memory! Get back in your circle!

DISGUST: Cool kids whispering at three o'clock!

FEAR: Did you see that look? They're judging us!

RILEY: *(Riley's smile fades; she begins to cry)* But everything's different now . . . Since we moved . . . .

FEAR: Oh no! We're CRYING AT SCHOOL! *(PING)*

NARRATOR 2: A new memory had been created and it was bright blue. Joy leaned over and pressed the end-of-day Memory Dump button, causing the vacuum tube to come down

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from the ceiling. *(Suction sounds and Joy and Sadness are sucked into the vacuum tube)* **(Pg 42)** Fear, Anger and Disgust were stunned.

DISGUST: We have a major problem.

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(Joy and Sadness land in a strange remote area the memory spheres fall all around them)

JOY: **(Pg 93-94)** *(as she is gathering the memories – she holds one up)* Oh, it's that time the hockey team showed up and Mom and Dad were there cheering – Look at her having fun and laughing. It's my favorite.

SADNESS: I love that one too . . . *(remembering)* It was the day the Prairie Dogs lost the big playoff game. Riley missed the winning shot. She felt awful. She wanted to quit.

NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 103)** Joy watched as the hockey team surrounded Riley, and suddenly she realized . . .

JOY: Mom and Dad . . . the team . . . they had come to help because of Sadness.

SADNESS: Sorry. I went sad again, didn't I? *(a stricken look appears on her face)*

JOY: **(Pg 34)** What is it?

SADNESS: You! YOU'RE not in Headquarters. Without you, Riley can't be happy.

JOY: **(Pg 68)** This way! Riley . . . here we come! *(Joy exits pulling Sadness with her)*

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NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 91– 92)** Meanwhile back at Headquarters . . .

FEAR: We were at school, and we were naked and there was a dog . . . .

ANGER: It was a DREAM! This is ridiculous, we can't even get a good night's sleep anymore. Time to take action! **(Pg 75)** All the good core memories were made in Minnesota. We go back to Minnesota and make more! *(Anger picks up a lightbulb-shaped idea)*

FEAR: Wait. You're saying we run away? You can't be serious . . . it's just so . . . drastic.

ANGER: Need I remind you how great things were there? Our room? Our backyard? Our friends? **(Pg 91)** Who's with me?

DISGUST: **(Pg 75)** Riley was happier in Minnesota . . . Yeah, let's do it.

ANGER: **(Pg 92)** *(Anger plugs the idea into the console)* She took it! There's no turning back!

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DISGUST: So, how're we gonna get to Minnesota from here?

ANGER: We're taking the bus!

DISGUST: How do we get money?

ANGER: Mom's purse. Mom and Dad got us into this mess. They can pay to get us out.

*****BOOOM! scene shift to Joy and Sadness******

JOY: **(Pg 94-95)** Honesty Island! We lost another island . . . . what is happening? *(as realization dawns)* Riley is running away.

NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 97-99)** Suddenly Sadness pointed to a memory recall tube. Normally the tubs were buried deep beneath the shelving of Long-Term Memory, but one of them had become exposed. If they got to it in time . . . .

SADNESS: We can get recalled! *(Joy and Sadness push against one another trying to get into the tube) –*

JOY: **(Pg 103)** We have to get back up there!!

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NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 106)** Riley's cell phone rang as she walked through the streets of San Francisco.

FEAR: It's Mom. She's on to us.

ANGER: **(Pg 109-110)** This is madness! She shouldn't run away.

DISGUST: Let's get this idea out of her head. *(Frantically pulling at the idea bulb in the console)*

ANGER: It's stuck.

DISGUST: Make her feel scared! That'll make her change her mind. *(Fear frantically pushes buttons and pulls levers, but nothing works.)*

FEAR: *(in frightened shock)* Guys, we can't make Riley feel anything!

ANGER: **(Pg 114-115)** AAAAAAAHHHHHHH! *(suddenly Joy and Sadness race into headquarters out of breath)*

DISGUST: Joy, you've got to fix this!

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JOY: *(shakes her head, then speaks to Sadness)* Sadness, it's up to you . . . Riley needs you.

(Sadness takes a deep breath and places both hands on the console. She gently removes the idea bulb)

RILEY: *(Standing up from her seat on the bus)* Wait! Stop! I want to get off!

NARRATOR 1: She got off the bus and ran toward home. And inside Headquarters Sadness was confidently driving. Joy pulled the yellow core memories out of her bag and handed them over to her. The memories all turned blue.

NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 116-117)** In the dining room, Riley cried as Sadness placed each memory, one at a time, into the recall unit.

RILEY: I know you don't want me to, but . . . I miss home. I miss Minnesota. You need me to be happy, but I want my old friends, and my hockey team.

NARRATOR 1: Her parents talked about all the things they missed about Minnesota and the three of them hugged as Riley continued to cry. Sadness took Joy's hand and placed it on the console alongside her own.

NARRATOR 2: And Riley smiled through her tears. *(DING)*

FEAR: **(Pg 121)** They love us!

ANGER: Yeah, Mom and Dad are pretty cool.

DISGUST: Guys, of course they are. But we can't show it!

NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 117)** A new core memory was made. This one was gold and blue swirled together . . . a first. A new Family Island rose, bigger and better than the last.

JOY: **(Pg 123)** Things might have gotten turned inside out

SADNESS: And even upside down

TOGETHER: But everything is going to be just fine.

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AWARD HISTORY

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